

INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE LT01

Unit 1 Aspects of dramatic tragedy

Mark scheme

January 2026

Version: 1.0 Final

Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Examiner.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

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Information for Examiners

Welcome to this mark scheme which is designed to help you to deliver fair and accurate assessment. Please read carefully all sections and ensure that you follow the requirements that they contain.

Arriving at marks

- 1 All questions are framed to address all the Assessment Objectives (AOs). Answers are marked holistically and when deciding upon a mark in a band, examiners should bear in mind the equal weightings of the Assessment Objectives. Examiners need to read the whole answer, taking into account its strengths and weaknesses, and then place it in the appropriate band.
- 2 Examiners should avoid making early snap judgements before the whole answer has been read. Some candidates begin tentatively but go on to make relevant points.
- 3 Examiners should be prepared to use the full mark range and not 'bunch' scripts in the middle for safety. Top marks are attainable if candidates could not be expected to do more in the time and under the conditions in which they are working.
- 4 Examiners should mark positively. Although the mark scheme provides some indicators for what candidates are likely to write about, examiners should be willing to reward what is actually there – provided, of course, that it is relevant to the question being asked.
- 5 Examiners should remember that there are no right answers. Candidates' views which are relevant, well-argued and supported by appropriate textual evidence must receive credit whether the examiner agrees with the views or not. It is important to try to remain flexible if a candidate introduces unusual or unorthodox ideas.
- 6 Examiners should remember that length and quality are not synonymous. Some brief answers may be relevant and concise. Equally, long answers may be diffuse and repetitive.
- 7 If answers are short or incomplete, examiners can reward only what is there and assess accordingly. Some further credit may be given to answers finished in note form.

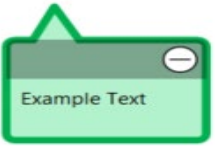
Using the mark bands

- 8 When placing answers in mark bands, examiners need to look closely at the descriptors and the detailed generic mark bands on pages 7–9. The key words for the bands are important and are printed below.

MARK BAND DESCRIPTORS	
Band 5	perceptive/assured
Band 4	coherent/thorough
Band 3	straightforward/relevant
Band 2	simple/generalised
Band 1	largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood, largely inaccurate

- 9 Answers placed at the top of the band will securely address the descriptors; answers at the lower end of the band will securely address the descriptors below and begin to show the qualities of the band into which you are placing them. Careful judgements need to be made about marks in the middle of the range; here it is likely that the key descriptors will be more intermittent but still clearly evident.
- 10 There will be occasions when an answer addresses descriptors in different bands; in such cases, the 'best-fit' model applies. Here examiners will need to exercise a different kind of judgement, looking to see where the answer can be most fairly and appropriately placed, in terms of its quality, against the descriptors.
- 11 Examiners must remember that the mark bands are not equivalent to grades: grades are decided by the awarding committee at the end of each session.

The following annotation is available for use on e-Marker 2:

Annotation Name	Toolbar Image	Details	Examples of Use on Script	Y/N
Annotation Type: Stamp				
Correct		Toolbar Tooltip: Correct		Y
Incorrect		Toolbar Tooltip: Incorrect		Y
Seen		Toolbar Tooltip: Seen		Y
Not Relevant		Toolbar Tooltip: Not Relevant		Y
Green Empty Comment		Toolbar Tooltip: Green Empty Comment No Default Text – text shown in screenshot was typed into annotation by user		Y
Repetition		Toolbar Tooltip: Repetition		Y
Lack Of Clarity		Toolbar Tooltip: Lack of Clarity		Y
Partially Made Point		Toolbar Tooltip: Partially made point		Y

The Assessment Objectives and their significance

- 12 All questions are framed to test AOs 1 and 2 so if candidates answer the question, then they will be addressing the AOs. In marking questions, however, examiners must also take account of AO3, which tests more than technical accuracy.

The equally weighted AOs are as follows:

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

Mark scheme

It is important to remember that these students, in the main, are 17 years old so we are judging their skills half way through Key Stage 5.

	AO	Typical features	How to arrive at mark
Band 5 Perceptive/Assured 21–25 marks ‘Perception’ is demonstrated when students are showing the depth of their understanding and responding sensitively to the texts and task. ‘Assuredness’ is shown when students write with confidence and conviction.	AO1	- Perceptive understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. - Assuredness in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to perceptive interpretations.	This band is characterised by perceptive and assured work which shows confidence, sharpness of mind and sophistication in relation to the task.
	AO2	- Perceptive understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. - Assured engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	At the top of the band students are consistently assured and will demonstrate sensitivity and perception across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response.
	AO3	- Perceptive, assured and sophisticated argument in relation to the task. - Assured use of literary critical concepts and terminology; mature and impressive expression.	At the bottom of the band there will be coherence and accuracy with some perception but with less consistency and evenness.
Band 4 Coherent/Thorough 16–20 marks ‘Coherence’ is shown when students are logical and consistent in their arguments in relation to the task. They hold their ideas together in an intelligible way. ‘Thoroughness’ is shown when students write carefully and precisely with detail.	AO1	- Thorough understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. - Coherence in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to carefully explained interpretations.	This band is characterised by coherent and thorough work where ideas are linked together in a focused and purposeful way in relation to the task.
	AO2	- Thorough understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. - Thorough engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	At the top of the band students will demonstrate a fully coherent and thorough argument across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response.
	AO3	- Logical, thorough and coherent argument in relation to the task where ideas are debated in depth. - Appropriate use of literary critical concepts and terminology; precise and accurate expression.	At the bottom of the band ideas will be discussed in a shaped, relevant and purposeful way with a clear sense of direction, with one or two lapses in coherence and accuracy.

Band 3 Straightforward/ Relevant 11–15 marks ‘Straightforward’ work is shown when students make their ideas in relation to the task clearly known. ‘Relevant’ work is shown when students are focused on the task and use detail in an appropriate and supportive way.	AO1	• Straightforward understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Relevant in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to straightforward interpretations.	This band is characterised by straightforward and relevant work where the student’s response to the task is clear and intelligible. At the top of the band students will demonstrate consistent straightforward understanding in the course of their argument. Ideas will be developed relevantly. At the bottom of the band there will be flashes of relevant understanding with evidence of straightforward thinking.
	AO2	• Straightforward understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Relevant engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Sensibly ordered ideas in a relevant argument in relation to the task. • Some use of literary critical concepts and terminology which are mainly appropriate; straightforward and clear expression.	
Band 2 Simple/Generalised 6–10 marks ‘Simple’ work is shown when students write in an unelaborated and basic way in relation to the task. ‘Generalised’ work is shown when students write without regard to particular details.	AO1	• Simple understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Generalised in the connections between contexts and genre, leading to simple interpretations.	This band is characterised by simple and generalised work which is mainly linked to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a basic generalised understanding in the course of their answer. Ideas will be developed in a simple way. At the bottom of the band there will be inconsistency, but the beginnings of a simple and generalised understanding.
	AO2	• Simple understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Generalised engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• A simple structure to the argument which may not be consistent but which does relate to the task. • Generalised use of literary critical concepts and terminology; simple expression.	

Band 1 Largely irrelevant/largely misunderstood/largely inaccurate 1–5 marks ‘Largely irrelevant’ work is shown when students write in an unclear way with only occasional reference to what is required by the question. ‘Largely misunderstood’ and ‘largely inaccurate’ work is shown when knowledge of the text is insecure, hazy and often wrong.	AO1	• Little sense of the AOs in relation to the task; little sense of how meanings are shaped; little sense of any relevant contexts, genre or interpretations.	This band is characterised by work which is largely irrelevant and largely misunderstood and largely inaccurate, and so unlikely to be addressing the AOs in a relevant way. At the top of the band students will mention some unconnected points in relation to the task during the course of their writing. The writing is likely to lack clarity. At the bottom of the band there will be no connection with the task; the writing will be hard to follow and irrelevant.
	AO2	• The writing is likely to be unclear and incorrect; if it is accurate the content will be irrelevant.	
	AO3	• Some vague points in relation to the task and some ideas about task and text(s).	
0 marks		No marks for response when nothing is written or where response has no connection to the text(s) or task.	

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Othello*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Othello and Iago
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Othello* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- elements of domestic tragedy and revenge drama
- pointed references to manhood
- ideas about savagery and bestial behaviour
- attitudes to women
- Iago's role as a trickster
- tragic knowledge and self-knowledge (or lack of it)
- the different ways in which an audience might respond to Othello in this scene.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the relationship of this extract to earlier parts of this scene
- the structure of the scene: Iago's repeated acts of stage management, Cassio present at the beginning and the end; Othello in the middle
- references to madness and ill-health
- Iago's direct address to the audience
- examples of mockery, black comedy
- Othello being reduced to the role of a spectator
- repetition used to drive home ideas: eg 'man'.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to other parts of the play may be more generalised than those from the passage.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	2
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William Shakespeare: *King Lear*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Goneril and Albany
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *King Lear* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- family ties, filial loyalty
- elements of romance – from one perspective a love scene
- ideas of manhood and gender roles
- the general reversal of values in the world of the play
- ideas about nature and what is natural
- the part played by the gods
- perhaps the development of Albany's character.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Albany's dramatic role
- dramatic ironies: eg Oswald described as 'trusty'
- Goneril's terseness in comparison with other speakers
- structure of the passage; changes of direction
- a sense of the play's general movement towards war
- ironic use of chivalric language
- bestial images.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to other parts of the play may be more generalised than those from the passage.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	3
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William Shakespeare: *Hamlet*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Horatio and Hamlet
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Hamlet* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the degree to which Hamlet has changed by this point in the play
- Hamlet the manipulator, dramatist, delight in his own cleverness
- ideas about life and death, guilt and justice, fate
- aspects of revenge tragedy
- Horatio's role: supportive listener, perhaps acts on behalf of the audience
- plots and villainy, a political world
- the importance of social rank.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the events which preceded this passage
- the language of theatre
- courtly discourse parodied
- Hamlet as a narrator of off-stage events and anticipating future action
- parallel established with Laertes
- reflections, philosophising
- the shape of the passage: increasing urgency.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to other parts of the play may be more generalised than those from the passage.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	4
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Christopher Marlowe: *Doctor Faustus*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Faustus, Mephistopheles and the Pope
- Marlowe's use of dramatic language
- the dramatic setting
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Doctor Faustus* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- aspects of Christian belief, perhaps anti-Catholic feeling, religious conflicts in sixteenth century Europe
- political power struggles: the Pope and the Emperor
- the Pope's autocratic exercise of power, perhaps rather like Faustus in that sense
- Faustus' delight in trivial pleasure, marking his decline. His self-indulgence: 'do what e'er I please'
- the relatively insignificant part he plays in this extract
- elements of low comedy
- the ways human pretensions are mocked.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the extract as one of a number of scenes in the middle of the play containing low comedy
- the promise of more trickery to come; the importance of preceding action
- the formality of Mephistopheles' opening speech
- the language of magic and trickery: 'charm', 'wand' etc
- the dramatic contrast between the two groups of characters
- hellish imagery
- the incantatory effect of the rhyming couplets
- exits and entrances.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to other parts of the play may be more generalised than those from the passage.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	5
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John Webster: *The Duchess of Malfi*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of the Ferdinand and the Doctor
- Webster's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues many strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Duchess of Malfi* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the corrupt world of the court
- the historical figure of Paracelsus, perhaps a contrast with the Doctor
- ideas of disease and sickness, sanity and madness
- Ferdinand's wolfishness
- his solitariness: the tragic villain
- the Doctor as a faintly comic, ineffective figure
- religious associations – the churchyard.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the relation of this extract to what precedes and follows it (eg Pescara's character and role in the previous scene)
- gothic, macabre tone
- the visual impact of the account of Ferdinand's behaviour
- stage action
- swift interchanges of dialogue
- perhaps echoes of Shakespeare plays (*Macbeth*, *King Lear*?)
- range of tone and mood within the scene
- use of verse and prose.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to other parts of the play may be more generalised than those from the passage.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	6
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Arthur Miller: *Death of a Salesman*

‘In *Death of a Salesman*, women are presented as either shadowy figures or tragic victims.’

To what extent do you agree with this view of the play?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Death of a Salesman* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Linda’s general subservience (eg Biff: ‘he always, always, wiped the floor with you’)
- Willy’s tendency to silence her: ‘Will you let me finish?’
- a counter-view, her understanding of Willy, her human sympathy for his tragic fall
- possible argument that her indulgence contributes to his fall
- Linda as the most fully developed female character: perhaps at times represents a possible audience view
- her clear-eyed view of her sons: ‘one a philandering bum’
- other more minor roles: an office secretary, two good-time girls – perhaps seen as commodities
- The Woman: the victim of Willy’s needs or a corrupting siren.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- dramatic symbols: eg the stockings
- the dramatic function of the Requiem and Linda’s significant part in it
- the complex dramatic function of The Woman: helps to destroy Biff’s illusions, a focus for Willy’s guilt
- the opening of the play as representative of the nature of Willy and Linda’s relationship; their dialogue
- the dramatic effects of the flashbacks
- the degree to which the women are represented by or defined by their physical surroundings
- their being constrained by their roles: wife, mother, work functionary; lover
- the dominance in the play of male relationships.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the play may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

07

Tennessee Williams: *A Streetcar Named Desire*

Consider the view that the tragic ending of *A Streetcar Named Desire* presents a bitter and disillusioned view of life. There are no ideals worth fighting for; life is simply a struggle for survival.

To what extent do you agree with this view of the play?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *A Streetcar Named Desire* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the possible relevance of Williams's own past
- an argument that – at the end of the play – the sense of bitter disillusionment might be felt most significantly by the audience rather than by any one individual character
- Stanley and Stella being prepared to sacrifice Blanche for their own selfish needs
- a counter-argument that Stella and Stanley represent the promise of growth and new life, as against Blanche's association with death
- Mitch being left crushed – another victim of the struggle for survival
- a general sense that life in the Quarter is all about survival
- Blanche's idealistic view of aspects of Southern culture never being likely to survive exposure to a more brutal reality
- Blanche as a tragic victim, ultimately punished for wanting something more. Perhaps her clinging to illusions until the end.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Blanche's flight from her Southern past perhaps representing tragic futility and the futility of ideals
- Steve's perhaps knowing final comment: 'This game is seven-card stud'
- Eunice's dramatic and choric function: 'You done the right thing'
- the violence and despair of the action in the closing scenes
- the dramatic structure of the play: the final scene as a culmination of what has gone before
- the dramatic function and significance of clothing and bathing
- the seeming final triumph of 'the blue piano'
- other non-verbal dramatic effects: lurid reflections, jungle cries etc.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the play may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	8
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Henrik Ibsen: *Hedda Gabler*

‘In *Hedda Gabler*, Hedda and Loevborg are presented as very different kind of rebels, and their rebellion is tragic in very different ways.’

To what extent do you agree with this view of the two characters?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Hedda Gabler* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- a view that Hedda’s rebellion is presented as a failure. Ultimately she achieves nothing, and life will go on without her
- a possible challenge to the whole idea that Hedda is a rebel of any kind
- Loevborg’s claim that he’s had his courage broken. Hedda’s responsibility for his defeat and death
- a view that in the end he did create something – even if unfinished
- the role of Tesman – connects both characters, but represents something very different
- the different reactions to their deaths
- Hedda’s own suggestion that Loevborg was more daring
- the degree to which their lives and deaths could be regarded as heroic.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Hedda’s early, perhaps anticipatory, use of her pistols; their tragic and dramatic function
- the stage setting: representing the stifling bourgeois world against which they wish to rebel
- the final meeting between Hedda and Loevborg, perhaps a turning point in the play
- the tragic and dramatic significance of the book – significantly compared to a child
- various parallels and connections between Hedda and Loevborg: tragic, dramatic and personal
- dramatic structure: the remorseless development of the action
- the significance of the past.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the play may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	9
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Samuel Beckett: *Waiting for Godot*

‘In the tragedy of *Waiting for Godot*, time is presented as an enemy.’

To what extent do you agree with this view of the play?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Waiting for Godot* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the idea of endlessly waiting itself suggesting lack of hope in the passage of time
- the failure to remember things; the past offering no comfort
- the characters’ difficulty in pinning down the time: ‘And is it Saturday? Is it not rather Sunday?’
- futile hopes: ‘Tomorrow everything will be better’
- the characters being trapped in an unending relationship: ‘How long have we been together all the time now?’
- The setting of the play not being securely fixed in time or space
- Pozzo’s rant: ‘have you not done tormenting me with your accursed time?’

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- structural patterns; the relationship of the two acts, various unsettling parallels
- the role of the boy: suggests that Godot will come tomorrow, but denies that he has been there before
- frequent references to death: the acknowledgement that death brings lifetime to an end
- the difficulty of deciding whether the sun is rising or setting
- verbal and visual repetitions: movements, phrases, pauses, silences – a sense of going nowhere
- circular dialogue – not progressing
- the symbol of Pozzo’s watch – which may have stopped.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the play may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

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Brian Friel: *Translations*

In *Translations*, to what extent is Yolland presented simply as a passive, tragic victim?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Translations* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- his being caught up in the history of England-Ireland conflict
- his being described as having a 'shy, awkward character'
- his developing and romantic attachment to the place and its language
- the degree to which he later stands up to Lancey: 'Your Irish air has made me bold'
- his sense of guilt and responsibility for what the English are doing
- the active role he plays in the love affair with Maire
- their relationship significantly involving ideas about communication – a central theme of the play
- the tragic and dramatic significance of his fate.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the dramatic contrast with Lancey: Yolland a 'soldier by accident'
- characteristic features of his speech: 'Sorry, sorry'
- the dramatic irony of his use of the word 'always'
- his back story – given some depth and context
- the significance of his engagement with the Irish language – represents his growth
- the minor part he plays earlier in the play: 'I've nothing to say – really'
- the developing structure of the play and his increasing significance
- his final and significant absence in the third act.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the play may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
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Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.